

Quick-Start Guide: Student / Researcher

Health Transformation Review (HTR) Platform

Your Role on HTR

As a student or researcher in health policy, economics, public health, or related fields, HTR gives you:

- Comprehensive, practitioner-level analysis across all six healthcare pillars
- Quantitative research tools for modeling and analysis
- A curated evidence library and glossary
- AI-powered research assistance trained on healthcare intelligence

Step 1: Set Your Role

At `/welcome`, click **"Student / Researcher"**.

The AI will open ready to help you explore health policy, economics, technology, clinical outcomes, equity, or operations — whatever your research focus.

Step 2: Orientation: The Six-Pillar Framework

Everything on HTR is organized around six pillars. Understanding this framework is your foundation.

Visit `/about/framework` for the interactive Six-Pillar Framework Map.

Pillar	Focus	Hub Route
Policy	Legislation, regulation, mandates	<code>/policy</code>
Economics	Value-based care, finance, markets	<code>/economics</code>
Technology	AI, digital health, FHIR, security	<code>/technology</code>
Clinical	Care innovation, population health	<code>/clinical</code>
Equity	SDOH, access, algorithmic bias	<code>/equity</code>
Operations	Revenue cycle, workforce, compliance	<code>/operations</code>

Each pillar has a hub page + 3–5 deep-dive sub-topic pages + dedicated Research Lab tools.

Step 3: Your 5 Most Valuable Destinations

1. Evidence Library — `/research-lab/knowledge-workspace?tab=evidence`

Curated research literature across all six pillars. Peer-reviewed studies, CMS technical reports, government white papers, and practitioner analyses. Searchable and filterable by topic.

2. AI Analyst — `/chat`

Your research accelerator. Ask any healthcare policy question in plain language:

- *"What is the evidence base for hospital-at-home programs?"*

- "Summarize the academic debate on whether Medicaid expansion improved population health."
- "What are the methodological strengths and weaknesses of Health Technology Assessment in the US vs. UK?"

3. HTR Glossary — /academy/glossary

Authoritative definitions for 500+ healthcare policy and industry terms. Searchable. Essential for anyone new to health policy, economics, or clinical terminology.

4. Research Lab — /research-lab

21 interactive modeling tools for hands-on research. For researchers, the most useful:

- **Policy Simulator** — model legislation impact
- **CEA Calculator** — cost-effectiveness methodology
- **Health Equity Studio** — equity gap analysis
- **Population Health Modeler** — disease burden and intervention modeling
- **Actuarial Lab** — coverage and cost projections

5. Case Studies — /academy/case-studies

Real-world analyses of APM implementations, state waiver programs, AI deployments, and equity initiatives. Excellent for literature review and understanding the practitioner perspective.

Step 4: Research Workflows

Literature Review on a Policy Topic

1. Start with the AI Analyst: "Give me an overview of the research on [topic] and the key debates"
2. Go to the **Evidence Library** and search your topic
3. Read HTR's in-depth analysis in the relevant pillar hub
4. Check **Case Studies** for real-world examples
5. Ask the AI for citations and further reading

Quantitative Policy Analysis

1. Use the **Policy Simulator** to model your research question
2. Build a population model in the **Population Health Modeler**
3. Run cost-effectiveness analysis in the **CEA Calculator**
4. Cross-reference findings with the **50-State Dashboard** for empirical data

Vermont-Specific Research

HTR has the deepest available coverage of Vermont's health system:

- **Vermont Medicaid** (/vermont-medicaid) — complete program overview
- **Vermont Act 167** (/vermont-act-167) — 2022 healthcare transformation law
- **Vermont Act 68** (/vermont-act-68) — 2025 legislation
- **Vermont RHT Program** (/vermont-rht-program) — rural health policy
- **CMS AHEAD Model** (/ahead-model) — Vermont's global budget participation
- **Vermont Hospital Profiles** (/dashboard/vermont/hospitals) — facility-level data

Comparative State Research

1. Use the **50-State Dashboard** (/dashboard) as your data foundation
2. Use **Dashboard > Compare** (/dashboard/compare) for side-by-side state comparison
3. Filter state data by Medicaid metrics, hospital capacity, health outcomes

4. Drill into individual hospital profiles for facility-level data

Step 5: Learning Tracks in the Academy

HTR Academy (/academy) has structured education aligned with research fields:

- **Personalized Learning** (/academy/personalized-learning) — AI builds your curriculum
- **Learning Tracks** (/academy/tracks) — multi-course sequences by topic
- **Webinars** (/academy/webinars) — live and recorded expert sessions
- **Glossary** (/academy/glossary) — terminology foundation

For researchers, the Webinar archive is particularly valuable — domain experts discussing current policy and research questions.

Step 6: Saving and Organizing Research

- **Bookmarks:** Click the bookmark icon on any page to save to **My Library** (/saved)
 - **My Library** organizes bookmarks by pillar — useful for literature review
 - **Research Workspace** (/research-lab/knowledge-workspace?tab=workspace) — multi-tool research environment
 - **AI Analyst history** persists within your session — use it to build a research thread
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Getting Help

- **AI Analyst:** Your primary research tool
 - **HTR Glossary:** /academy/glossary — start here for terminology
 - **Ask HTR:** /connect/ask — submit research questions to domain experts
 - **Pillar Circles:** /connect/forums — peer discussion with practitioners
 - **Voice:** Press ⌘⇧V for hands-free queries while reading
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